Lenzi 2023 – *Suffering in Babylon: Ludlul bēl nēmeqi and the Scholars, Ancient and Modern*

- **Author:** Alan Lenzi. **Series:** Orbis Biblicus et Orientalis 300 (Leuven: Peeters, 2023), 538 pp. ISBN 978-90-429-5096-2, eISBN 978-90-429-5097-9.
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Contents

File	What
`OBO_300_Lenzi_Suffering_in_Babylon.pdf`	The book (8 MB).
`full-text.txt`	`pdftotext -layout` extraction (25,129 lines; diacritics kept, line breaks and page headers as printed).

Where things are in `full-text.txt` (line numbers of the extraction):

- **Chapter 2, composite text in transcription and English translation** (Lenzi's own normalization and translation, on facing pages): Tablet I from l. 3443 (transcription) / 3488 (translation); II 3724 / 3768; III 4004 / 4048; IV 4335 / 4383; V 4452 / 4498.
- **Chapter 3, selected notes on the Akkadian text and translation** (philology, readings, other translations): from l. 4793 to about 8700, by tablet (3.1–3.5).
- Chapter 5 (the divinatory context, the bad omens and dreams of Tablet I and III), chapter 6 (**the anatomical and pathological vocabulary**: every body part and disease word of Tablet II), chapter 7 (the poem as a defence of the exorcist's craft), chapter 8 (**Ludlul and the incantation prayers**: the hymnic introduction, lament, petition), chapter 9 (**edition of the ancient commentary** K 3291 and the ancient lexical equations), chapter 10 (Ludlul reused: *The Forlorn Scholar*, Nabonidus's Ḫarran inscription, Aššurbanipal's lament), chapter 11 (II 71–85, the *alû* demon and sleep paralysis).

Line numbering

Lenzi follows **Oshima 2014** (Tablets I–V, 120 lines each) unless noted. eBL (Hätinen) agrees in I, II and V for most lines; **III and IV differ** (eBL III `a+1`, `a+2`, `b+1` for Oshima's III 111–112; eBL IV `a+`, `b+`, `c+`, `d+` sections for Oshima's IV 1–120, partly arranged differently). Align by content, using the Akkadian.

Usefulness

Rank 3 (translation) and rank 4 (philology) for the whole of Ludlul, the most recent full study (after Oshima 2014 and Annus & Lenzi 2010), and the only one we have. Its chapters 5–9 are the best guide we have to Ludlul on its own terms (divination, the exorcist, the body, the prayers, the ancient commentary). Consult it *after* forming your own reading of each line (guidelines §3).